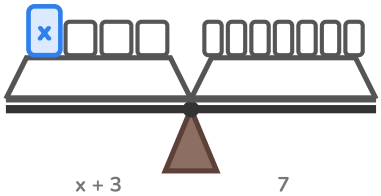
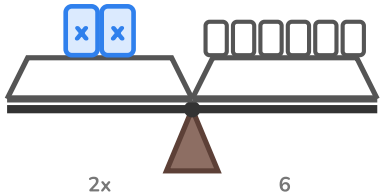
BALANCE THE SCALES

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

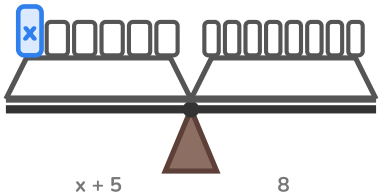
Each scale is balanced. A box weighs x and every small block weighs 1. Write the equation the scale shows, then find x by taking the same thing off both sides.

1. 

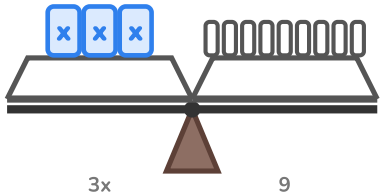
x =

2. 

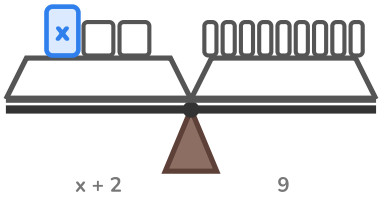
x =

3. 

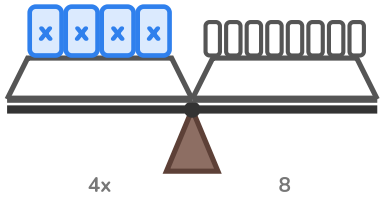
x =

4. 

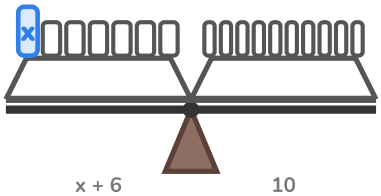
x =

5. 

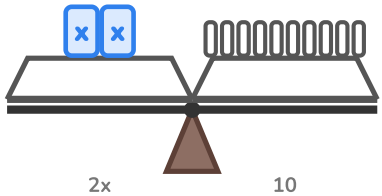
x =

6. 

x =

7. 

x =

8. 

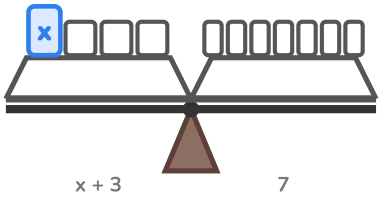
x =

Worked example: a box and 3 blocks balance 7 blocks: x + 3 = 7. Take 3 blocks off each side: x = 4. Two boxes balancing 6 blocks: 2x = 6, so each box is 3.

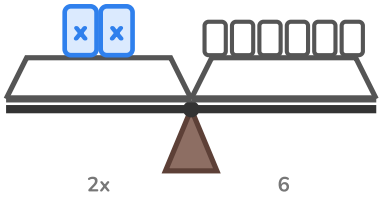
BALANCE THE SCALES ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

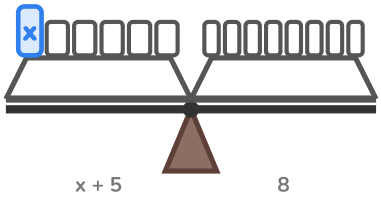
Answer key: the equation each scale shows and the value of x.

1. 

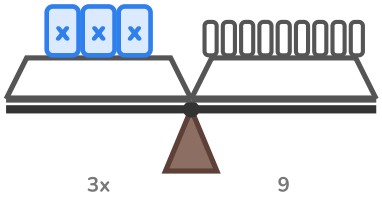
x + 3 = 7
x = 4

2. 

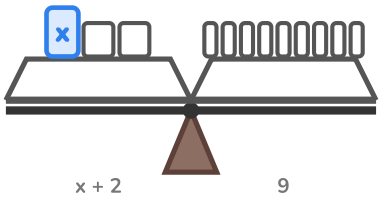
2x = 6
x = 3

3. 

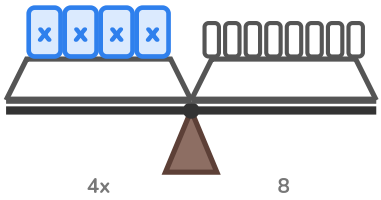
x + 5 = 8
x = 3

4. 

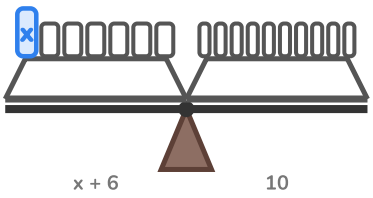
3x = 9
x = 3

5. 

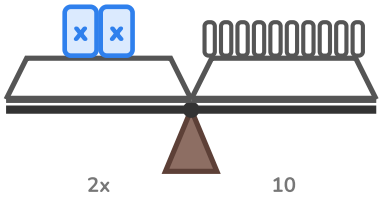
x + 2 = 9
x = 7

6. 

4x = 8
x = 2

7. 

x + 6 = 10
x = 4

8. 

2x = 10
x = 5

Worked example: a box and 3 blocks balance 7 blocks: x + 3 = 7. Take 3 blocks off each side: x = 4. Two boxes balancing 6 blocks: 2x = 6, so each box is 3.